

Government of West Bengal
Department of School Education
Bikash Bhavan, 6th Floor, Salt Lake, Kolkata – 700091

Memo No.197-SSE/2026

Date:16/09/2026

From: Binod Kumar, IAS
Additional Chief Secretary to the Govt. of West Bengal
School Education Department

To: (i) District Magistrate, All Districts
(ii) Municipal Commissioner, KMC

Sub.: Physical verification and assessment of utilization of infrastructural assets of Zero-Enrolment Schools and proposal for their suitable utilization/revival under PPP mode.

Ref.: Memo No. 574-CMO/1E-48/2026 dated 21/08/2026 of CMO, WB.

Madam/Sir,

It has come to the notice of the School Education Department that a number of schools under the jurisdiction of different districts are presently having zero enrolment, resulting in the under-utilization/idle status of valuable educational infrastructure and other associated assets created out of public expenditure.

In this context, it has been decided that a physical verification of all such Zero-Enrolment Schools under the respective jurisdiction of each district may be undertaken to assess the present status and condition of the school buildings, classrooms, ancillary infrastructure, land and other available assets, as well as their scope for future utilization.

You are, therefore, requested to kindly constitute a District-level Committee comprising the following members:

1. District Magistrate – Chairperson
2. District Education Officer – Member
3. District Inspector of Schools concerned – Member
4. Any other officer as may be deemed fit by the District Magistrate

The Committee may undertake/oversee the following activities:

1. Physical verification of all Zero-Enrolment Schools in the district and preparation of an inventory of the infrastructural assets available in each such institution.
2. Assessment of the present physical condition, ownership/status of land and buildings, availability of basic amenities, accessibility and other relevant aspects of the assets.
3. Identification of schools/buildings or other infrastructural assets which are lying idle or under-utilized and assessment of their suitability for alternative public purposes, keeping in view the local requirements.
4. Preparation of suitable proposals for utilization of such infrastructure for activities such as Training Centres, Health Centres, ARD Centres, community/public service facilities or other suitable Government/public purposes, in consultation with the concerned departments/authorities, wherever necessary. However, it

should be kept in mind that no child is deprived of the schooling facility and that he should have access to school.

5. Wherever revival of the school infrastructure for educational purposes is considered feasible, the Committee may examine the possibility of revival/restructuring of the institution.

A district-wise consolidated report, along with the details of each zero-enrolment school and the recommendation of the Committee regarding:

- (i) continuation/revival of the institution,
- (ii) alternative utilization of the infrastructure for suitable public purposes, may be furnished to the Commissioner, School Education within 30 days from the date of receipt of this communication.

The proposals received from the districts will be examined at the appropriate level and, wherever considered necessary, a consolidated proposal for revival of zero-enrolment schools and/or alternative utilization of the associated infrastructural assets shall be placed before the competent authority for consideration. Due processing of assets including land will be processed expeditiously.

It is requested that the exercise may be accorded top priority, keeping in view the objective of ensuring optimal and productive utilization of public assets while simultaneously addressing the educational and other public service requirements of the respective areas as per RTE rules.

Your cooperation in this regard is earnestly solicited.

With regards,

Enclo.: As stated above.

Yours faithfully,

BK
16/9/26

(Binod Kumar)

Additional Chief Secretary

Memo No.197/1(3)-SSE/2026

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Copy forwarded for information to:

1. Commissioner of School Education, West Bengal.
2. State Project Director, PBSSM.
3. Under Secretary, Home & OSD to Chief Secretary, West Bengal

BK
16/9/26

(Binod Kumar)

Additional Chief Secretary